NAVIGSA

Product Backlog

User stories and tasks for the NavigSA project

Project	NavigSA (Navigate SA – Student Application Services)
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Lecturer	Bhadra Ranchod
Project period	14 July – 30 October 2026 (working days Tuesday – Friday)
Last updated	27 October 2026
Backlog size	36 user stories · 276 tasks · each task sized at about one working day

1. About this backlog

The Product Backlog is the single ordered list of everything the NavigSA team needs to deliver. Each entry is a **user story** with a unique ID, written in the format *As a [role], I want [goal], so that [benefit]*, followed by the tasks that deliver it. Items are listed in backlog order. Sprints are drawn from this list and the **Sprint coverage** column shows where each story was worked on in the Sprint Backlog.

US-01 Unique user story ID. Tasks use the same ID plus a number, e.g. US-01.1.

Part A Original product backlog: the 15 core work streams.

Part B Expanded backlog: customer-facing and supporting stories (US-16 to US-36).

Sprints 1, 2, 4 Sprints in which the story was worked on.

Note on the technology stack. The technology stack in the original plan was later adjusted during implementation. The completed website is deployed on Vercel and uses Supabase. Story numbers in Part B were 11–31 in the earlier document; they now continue the sequence from US-16 so every ID is unique.

2. Backlog overview

ID	User story	Part	Tasks	Sprint coverage
US-01	Community and Market Research	A	9	Sprints 5–7
US-02	Business Concept Definition	A	12	Sprints 1–2, 4
US-03	Feasibility and Business Planning	A	6	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-04	Presentation Development and Delivery	A	3	Sprints 3, 8
US-05	Trust, Verification, and Governance Design	A	5	Sprints 26–27
US-06	MVP Design and Validation Testing	A	8	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-07	Platform Design (UI/UX)	A	5	Sprints 9–13
US-08	System Architecture and Technical Design	A	5	Sprints 17–20
US-09	Website Development: Setup and Backend	A	14	Sprints 21–25, 28, 38

ID	User story	Part	Tasks	Sprint coverage
US-10	Website Development: Frontend	A	10	Sprints 29–35, 37
US-11	Website Testing and Launch	A	5	Sprints 36, 39–43, 48
US-12	Content Development and Translation	A	4	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-13	Marketing and Launch	A	7	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-14	Operations and Compliance	A	5	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-15	Final Academic Documentation	A	2	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-16	View Student Dashboard	B	7	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-17	Track Application Status	B	9	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-18	Book NavigSA Service	B	8	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-19	Register as Service Provider	B	8	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-20	Become a Verified Service Provider	B	7	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-21	Administrator Manages Users	B	7	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-22	Submit Reviews	B	8	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-23	View Testimonials	B	8	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-24	Access Multilingual Content	B	6	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-25	Receive Notifications and Reminders	B	9	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-26	Learn Through Educational Content	B	10	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-27	Discover NavigSA Through Marketing	B	10	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-28	Build Strategic Partnerships	B	10	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-29	Protect Student Information (Operations and Compliance)	B	12	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-30	Use a Reliable Platform (Testing and QA)	B	16	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-31	Access Live Platform (Deployment and Launch)	B	9	Sprints 44–47
US-32	Present Project Progress	B	9	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-33	Complete Final Academic Documentation	B	11	Not in Sprint Backlog
US-34	Develop and Present NavigSA Brand Guide	B	4	Sprint 15
US-35	Maintain Agile Project Documentation	B	4	Sprint 14
US-36	Prepare and Submit Monthly Project Reports	B	4	Sprints 16, 50

3. Part A – Original product backlog

The 15 core work streams, with task ownership as agreed by the team.

US-01 Community and Market Research

Sprints 5–7 | 9 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to research our target community and validate the real problem, **so that** we build NavigSA on evidence rather than assumptions.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-01.1	Identify and define the target online community of international students	@Tanatswa
US-01.2	Assign team roles and areas of expertise	@Team
US-01.3	Research demographics and platform habits of international students	@Tanatswa
US-01.4	Identify who is affected by the problem and their shared characteristics	@Tanatswa
US-01.5	Identify how often the problem occurs (seasonal recurrence)	@Tanatswa
US-01.6	Explain why the problem is worth solving	@Tanatswa
US-01.7	Conduct structured interviews with prospective students and service providers	@Team
US-01.8	Document and analyse interview findings and pain points	@Tanatswa
US-01.9	Confirm problem urgency and willingness to pay from research data	@Team

US-02 Business Concept Definition

Sprints 1–2, 4 | 12 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to define our business concept, services, and value proposition, **so that** we have a clear, well-justified idea to present and build.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-02.1	Write the NavigSA problem statement	@Team
US-02.2	Define the NavigSA solution and business idea	@Team
US-02.3	Define the six NavigSA service offerings	@Team
US-02.4	Map each identified problem to a NavigSA solution approach	@Team
US-02.5	Segment and define Primary, Secondary, and Tertiary beneficiaries	@Team
US-02.6	Define customer profile, decision maker, and persona (WHO)	@Nolwazi
US-02.7	Define customer benefits and core value drivers (WHAT)	@Team
US-02.8	Map marketing and information channels (WHERE)	@Team
US-02.9	Map seasonal buying behaviour and timing (WHEN)	@Team
US-02.10	Define trust pillars and competitor comparison (WHY)	@Team
US-02.11	Write the NavigSA value proposition statement	@Team
US-02.12	Compile the reference list for Deliverable 1	@Tanatswa

US-03 Feasibility and Business Planning

6 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to assess the feasibility of NavigSA, **so that** we can confirm it is realistic to launch with our resources.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-03.1	Calculate estimated startup costs	@Team
US-03.2	Identify required skills, people, and roles	@Team
US-03.3	Identify tools and platforms needed to build and run NavigSA	@Marc
US-03.4	Document operational risks and mitigation strategies	@Team
US-03.5	Write the feasibility conclusion	@Team
US-03.6	Define service packages, pricing, and break-even point	@Team

US-04 Presentation Development and Delivery

Sprints 3, 8 · 3 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to prepare and deliver our WIL presentations, **so that** our supervisor can assess our progress at each milestone.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-04.1	Create initial slide deck content and structure for Project Presentation 3 (14 July 2026)	@Team
US-04.2	Present NavigSA business concept for Project Presentation 3 (16 July 2026)	@Nolwazi
US-04.3	Revise presentation to incorporate market research findings (21 July 2026)	@Team

US-05 Trust, Verification, and Governance Design

Sprints 26–27 · 5 tasks

> **As** NavigSA, **we want** to design our verification, onboarding, and review systems, **so that** students and providers can trust the platform.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-05.1	Define student verification requirements and accepted documents	@Team
US-05.2	Define service provider onboarding and accreditation requirements	@Team
US-05.3	Define approval workflow for the NavigSA Verified badge	@Team
US-05.4	Define testimonial and review submission rules	@Witcha
US-05.5	Define refund policy for document errors on rejected applications	@Team

US-06 MVP Design and Validation Testing

8 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to run a low-cost MVP test, **so that** we validate real demand before investing in a full build.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-06.1	Define MVP test hypotheses and success thresholds	@Team
US-06.2	Day 1: Create NavigSA WhatsApp Business profile and Instagram page	@Team
US-06.3	Day 2: Share free multilingual SAQA checklist in targeted Facebook groups	@Tanatswa
US-06.4	Day 3: Post Instagram poll and message every respondent	@Witcha
US-06.5	Day 4: Post short-form video on common application mistakes	@Witcha
US-06.6	Day 5: Send WhatsApp broadcast introducing the Standard Package	@Team
US-06.7	Day 6: Follow up with respondents and book trial consultations	@Team
US-06.8	Day 7: Record results and decide whether to scale	@Team

US-07 Platform Design (UI/UX)

Sprints 9–13 · 5 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to design the platform's look, feel, and user flows, **so that** development starts from a clear, agreed design.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-07.1	Create wireframes for the NavigSA website (21 July 2026)	@Marc
US-07.2	Finalise NavigSA branding: logo, colour palette, and fonts	@Marc
US-07.3	Design user flow for student registration and verification	@Marc
US-07.4	Design user flow for provider onboarding	@Marc
US-07.5	Design layout structure for multilingual content pages	@Witcha

US-08 System Architecture and Technical Design

Sprints 17–20 · 5 tasks

> **As a** development team, **we want** to define our system architecture, **so that** the platform is built on a solid, well-planned technical foundation.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-08.1	Decide on the technology stack (original plan: Spring Boot, React, MySQL, Railway)	@Marc
US-08.2	Draw the system architecture diagram	@Marc
US-08.3	Define the API architecture and endpoint structure	@Marc
US-08.4	Define the security architecture	@Marc
US-08.5	Define the deployment architecture	@Marc

US-09 Website Development: Setup and Backend

Sprints 21–25, 28, 38 · 14 tasks

> **As a** development team, **we want** to build the backend, **so that** student and provider data can be stored and served securely.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-09.1	Set up GitHub repository and branch structure	@Marc
US-09.2	Create backend project skeleton	@Marc
US-09.3	Create database schema for students, providers, services, and testimonials	@Tanatswa
US-09.4	Create database entity classes and relationships	@Marc
US-09.5	Configure database connection and environment	@Marc
US-09.6	Develop student registration API	@Marc
US-09.7	Develop student document upload and verification API	@Marc
US-09.8	Develop provider registration API	@Marc
US-09.9	Develop provider document upload and admin approval API	@Marc
US-09.10	Develop testimonial and review APIs	@Marc
US-09.11	Develop service listing and package APIs	@Marc
US-09.12	Implement authentication and login	@Marc
US-09.13	Write unit tests for backend APIs	@Marc
US-09.14	Deploy/configure backend services	@Marc

US-10 Website Development: Frontend

Sprints 29–35, 37 · 10 tasks

> **As a** development team, **we want** to build the frontend, **so that** students and providers have a working interface.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-10.1	Create React frontend skeleton	@Marc
US-10.2	Develop homepage UI	@Marc
US-10.3	Develop services and pricing UI	@Marc
US-10.4	Develop about and team UI	@Marc
US-10.5	Create student registration and verification form	@Marc
US-10.6	Create provider registration and onboarding form	@Marc
US-10.7	Create testimonial submission and display	@Marc
US-10.8	Connect frontend forms to backend services	@Marc
US-10.9	Implement responsive mobile styling	@Marc
US-10.10	Deploy frontend to Vercel	@Marc

US-11 Website Testing and Launch

Sprints 36, 39–43, 48 | 5 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to test and launch the website, **so that** it is stable and ready for users.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-11.1	Conduct frontend/backend integration testing	@Team
US-11.2	Fix identified bugs	@Marc
US-11.3	Conduct user acceptance testing with sample students and providers	@Team
US-11.4	Complete final live website review	@Team
US-11.5	Launch the website	@Team

US-12 Content Development and Translation

4 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to produce multilingual content, **so that** students can understand processes in their own language.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-12.1	Develop multilingual guides for SAQA, visas, and applications	@Tanatswa
US-12.2	Create YouTube tutorials in French and Portuguese	@Witcha
US-12.3	Create short-form Instagram/TikTok explainers	@Witcha
US-12.4	Develop partnerships with certified translators	@Team

US-13 Marketing and Launch

7 tasks

> **As** NavigSA, **we want** to market and promote the platform, **so that** we can reach and convert our target audience.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-13.1	Populate Facebook, Instagram, and WhatsApp	@Team
US-13.2	Prepare WhatsApp deadline reminders	@Team
US-13.3	Promote NavigSA organically in Facebook study groups	@Team
US-13.4	Plan paid Facebook/Instagram campaign	@Team
US-13.5	Create referral programme and discount	@Team
US-13.6	Build partnerships with language schools and community groups	@Team
US-13.7	Create a 2026 seasonal marketing calendar	@Team

US-14 Operations and Compliance

5 tasks

> **As** NavigSA, **we want** to establish compliant and secure operations, **so that** the platform can operate responsibly.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-14.1	Address POPIA data handling	@Team
US-14.2	Define cybersecurity safeguards	@Marc
US-14.3	Establish support process	@Team
US-14.4	Monitor SAQA, Home Affairs, and university updates	@Tanatswa
US-14.5	Quality-assure translated content	@Witcha

US-15 Final Academic Documentation

2 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to compile academic deliverables and reports, **so that** project work is documented and submitted.

Task ID	Task	Owner
US-15.1	Compile group report	@Team
US-15.2	Compile individual reports	@Team

4. Part B – Expanded user stories and supporting tasks

Additional customer-facing stories and project-support items included in the expanded backlog used in planning.

US-16 View Student Dashboard

7 tasks

> **As a** student, **I want** to view a dashboard, **so that** I can access my profile, documents, service bookings, and updates in one place.

Task ID	Task
US-16.1	Design dashboard in Figma
US-16.2	Create dashboard layout and React page
US-16.3	Display profile summary and uploaded documents
US-16.4	Display verification status, booked services, appointments, notifications, recent activity, and quick actions
US-16.5	Connect dashboard to backend services
US-16.6	Test dashboard and fix defects
US-16.7	Conduct usability review

US-17 Track Application Status

9 tasks

> **As a** student, **I want** to track my application status, **so that** I understand progress and know what actions remain.

Task ID	Task
US-17.1	Design application status page
US-17.2	Define application stages
US-17.3	Create status service/API
US-17.4	Display current status and completed steps
US-17.5	Display outstanding tasks and rejected documents
US-17.6	Display approval history and processing information
US-17.7	Configure status notifications
US-17.8	Connect frontend and backend
US-17.9	Test and fix defects

US-18 Book NavigSA Service

8 tasks

> **As a** student, **I want** to book a NavigSA service, **so that** I can request the support I need.

Task ID	Task
US-18.1	Design booking flow
US-18.2	Display available services, packages, and pricing
US-18.3	Create booking form and validation
US-18.4	Create booking service/API and store bookings
US-18.5	Display booking confirmation and success message
US-18.6	Display booking history
US-18.7	Support cancellation where applicable
US-18.8	Test and fix defects

US-19 Register as Service Provider

8 tasks

> **As a** service provider, **I want** to register on NavigSA, **so that** I can offer services to students.

Task ID	Task
US-19.1	Design provider registration flow
US-19.2	Create registration page and API/service
US-19.3	Validate submitted information
US-19.4	Store provider information
US-19.5	Allow accreditation/business document uploads
US-19.6	Prevent duplicate registrations
US-19.7	Display confirmation and success message
US-19.8	Test and fix defects

US-20 Become a Verified Service Provider

7 tasks

> **As a** service provider, **I want** to become verified, **so that** students can identify providers whose credentials have been reviewed.

Task ID	Task
US-20.1	Define verification criteria
US-20.2	Review accreditation and supporting documents
US-20.3	Approve or reject verification requests
US-20.4	Display verified badge
US-20.5	Notify providers of decisions
US-20.6	Maintain verification history
US-20.7	Test and fix defects

US-21 Administrator Manages Users

7 tasks

> **As an** administrator, **I want** to manage user accounts, **so that** I can maintain appropriate platform access.

Task ID	Task
US-21.1	Design admin dashboard
US-21.2	Provide administrator login
US-21.3	View and search users
US-21.4	Approve, reject, suspend, and reactivate accounts where applicable
US-21.5	Review submitted documents
US-21.6	Generate or view relevant reports
US-21.7	Test and fix defects

US-22 Submit Reviews

8 tasks

> **As a** user, **I want** to submit a review, **so that** I can share feedback about a service.

Task ID	Task
US-22.1	Design review form and page
US-22.2	Create review service/API
US-22.3	Store reviews
US-22.4	Allow star ratings and comments
US-22.5	Support editing or deleting where applicable
US-22.6	Moderate reviews
US-22.7	Display confirmation
US-22.8	Test and fix defects

US-23 View Testimonials

8 tasks

> **As a** visitor, **I want** to view testimonials, **so that** I can learn about other users' experiences.

Task ID	Task
US-23.1	Design testimonials section
US-23.2	Collect testimonials
US-23.3	Approve testimonials before publication
US-23.4	Display approved testimonials
US-23.5	Display names only when permitted
US-23.6	Display ratings and associated services where available
US-23.7	Create testimonial slider if applicable
US-23.8	Test and fix defects

US-24 Access Multilingual Content

6 tasks

> **As an** international student, **I want** to access content in a language I understand, **so that** I can follow NavigSA guidance.

Task ID	Task
US-24.1	Identify languages to support
US-24.2	Translate homepage, services, registration, guides, FAQs, and notifications as applicable
US-24.3	Provide language selector
US-24.4	Test translated content
US-24.5	Review translations for accuracy
US-24.6	Fix identified issues

US-25 Receive Notifications and Reminders

9 tasks

> **As a** student, **I want** to receive relevant notifications and reminders, **so that** I do not miss important actions or deadlines.

Task ID	Task
US-25.1	Define notification types
US-25.2	Plan notification system
US-25.3	Provide booking and registration confirmations
US-25.4	Provide verification updates
US-25.5	Provide document reminders
US-25.6	Prepare SAQA, university, and visa reminders
US-25.7	Plan WhatsApp broadcasts where appropriate
US-25.8	Provide in-app notifications where supported
US-25.9	Test and fix defects

US-26 Learn Through Educational Content

10 tasks

> **As an** international student, **I want** to access educational content, **so that** I can better understand application processes.

Task ID	Task
US-26.1	Identify educational topics
US-26.2	Research relevant processes
US-26.3	Write guides
US-26.4	Translate content
US-26.5	Review content for accuracy
US-26.6	Prepare PDF resources
US-26.7	Create YouTube content
US-26.8	Create Instagram/TikTok content
US-26.9	Publish resources
US-26.10	Review and update information

US-27 Discover NavigSA Through Marketing

10 tasks

> **As a** prospective user, **I want** to discover NavigSA through relevant channels, **so that** I can learn about the platform.

Task ID	Task
US-27.1	Set up/populate Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, LinkedIn, and TikTok channels as appropriate
US-27.2	Apply consistent branding
US-27.3	Prepare banners and launch posts
US-27.4	Prepare educational posts
US-27.5	Create stories, reels, and TikTok content
US-27.6	Share relevant content in student groups
US-27.7	Respond to engagement and enquiries
US-27.8	Maintain a content calendar
US-27.9	Schedule posts
US-27.10	Track available metrics

US-28 Build Strategic Partnerships

10 tasks

> **As** NavigSA, **we want** to build strategic partnerships, **so that** students can access trustworthy services and referrals.

Task ID	Task
US-28.1	Identify language schools, translators, immigration support, accommodation, and university partners
US-28.2	Research certified translators and relevant organisations
US-28.3	Contact prospective partners
US-28.4	Arrange meetings
US-28.5	Prepare partnership proposals
US-28.6	Discuss agreements and referrals
US-28.7	Plan partner onboarding and verification
US-28.8	Maintain partner database
US-28.9	Communicate with partners
US-28.10	Review partnership effectiveness

US-29 Protect Student Information (Operations and Compliance)

12 tasks

> **As a** student, **I want** my personal information to be handled securely, **so that** I can use NavigSA with confidence.

Task ID	Task
US-29.1	Address POPIA requirements
US-29.2	Prepare privacy, terms, refund, and cookie information as applicable
US-29.3	Review authentication and access controls
US-29.4	Consider encryption and secure document handling
US-29.5	Review database security
US-29.6	Define role-based access controls
US-29.7	Use HTTPS for the live site
US-29.8	Plan backups and disaster recovery
US-29.9	Monitor relevant regulatory and service updates
US-29.10	Establish user support process
US-29.11	Define incident response procedure
US-29.12	Conduct security review

US-30 Use a Reliable Platform (Testing and QA)

16 tasks

> **As a** user, **I want** NavigSA to work reliably, **so that** I can use its available features without unnecessary problems.

Task ID	Task
US-30.1	Prepare test plan and test cases
US-30.2	Test homepage
US-30.3	Test registration and login
US-30.4	Test profile and document uploads where supported
US-30.5	Test booking functionality where supported
US-30.6	Test provider functions where supported
US-30.7	Test administrator functions where supported
US-30.8	Test multilingual content where supported
US-30.9	Test notifications where supported
US-30.10	Test responsive layout
US-30.11	Test frontend/backend integration and data handling
US-30.12	Conduct user acceptance testing
US-30.13	Record defects
US-30.14	Fix defects
US-30.15	Retest corrected functionality
US-30.16	Record final review

US-31 Access Live Platform (Deployment and Launch)

Sprints 44–47 · 9 tasks

> **As a** user, **I want** to access the live NavigSA website, **so that** I can use the platform online.

Task ID	Task
US-31.1	Configure production services and database as applicable
US-31.2	Configure environment variables securely
US-31.3	Configure domain and SSL where applicable
US-31.4	Deploy the frontend to Vercel
US-31.5	Run live-site tests
US-31.6	Monitor the deployed website
US-31.7	Resolve launch issues
US-31.8	Prepare launch announcement
US-31.9	Monitor initial user activity where available

US-32 Present Project Progress

9 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to present NavigSA's progress, **so that** our supervisor can assess the project and its outcomes.

Task ID	Task
US-32.1	Confirm presentation requirements
US-32.2	Allocate presentation sections
US-32.3	Prepare business concept and market research sections
US-32.4	Prepare UI/UX and technical architecture sections
US-32.5	Prepare MVP and website screenshots
US-32.6	Practise the presentation
US-32.7	Present project progress
US-32.8	Record feedback
US-32.9	Update presentation where needed

US-33 Complete Final Academic Documentation

11 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to complete academic documentation, **so that** the project meets submission requirements.

Task ID	Task
US-33.1	Compile group and individual reports
US-33.2	Format documents consistently
US-33.3	Check Harvard referencing
US-33.4	Proofread grammar and spelling
US-33.5	Prepare figures and tables
US-33.6	Include relevant screenshots
US-33.7	Prepare appendices
US-33.8	Check assessment requirements
US-33.9	Obtain team review/approval
US-33.10	Submit required documentation
US-33.11	Archive final deliverables

US-34 Develop and Present NavigSA Brand Guide

Sprint 15 | 4 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to document NavigSA's brand identity, **so that** our project materials have a consistent visual style.

Task ID	Task
US-34.1	Develop the Brand Guide
US-34.2	Document logo, colour palette, and fonts
US-34.3	Review brand consistency
US-34.4	Present the Brand Guide

US-35 Maintain Agile Project Documentation

Sprint 14 | 4 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to maintain sprint boards and the Agile Logbook, **so that** our work and progress are recorded.

Task ID	Task
US-35.1	Create and organise sprint boards
US-35.2	Record Product Backlog and Sprint Backlog tasks
US-35.3	Maintain the Agile Logbook
US-35.4	Review board structure and task traceability

US-36 Prepare and Submit Monthly Project Reports

Sprints 16, 50 | 4 tasks

> **As a** project team, **we want** to prepare monthly reports and registers, **so that** project progress is formally documented.

Task ID	Task
US-36.1	Prepare monthly project report
US-36.2	Prepare monthly register
US-36.3	Review report and register for completeness
US-36.4	Submit required monthly documentation